

Nothing Phone (2)

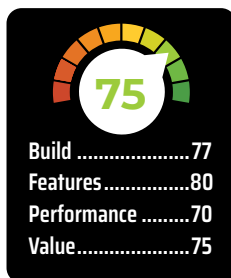
Something special

Nothing. It's too early to award this brand "legendary" status – which the likes of Apple, Samsung, and Google have gotten over the years – but it definitely looks like it's on the way. The genius of Carl Pei's marketing combined with the idiosyncratic design characteristics of Nothing products lead to these gadgets being some of the most hyped to ever exist. And "nothing" (heh) changed with the new Nothing Phone (2). The similarity in the design compared to the Phone (1) may disappoint some, but one cannot deny the Phone (2) has improved specs almost all the way across the board. However, this comes at quite a steep price hike. So, is the Nothing Phone (2) worth it or is it "nothing" special? Let's delve deeper.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Nothing Phone (2) could easily be confused for the Phone (1) at first glance. The Phone (2) has a thin aluminium frame with transparent glass on the back. It is 8.6 mm thick and weighs 201.2 g – not too bad. The biggest change in design when compared to the Phone (1) is the curved rear glass. It is protected by Gorilla Glass (but Nothing hasn't disclosed the version). I'm glad Nothing went for the curved glass approach over the complete flat look, since it is not only nicer to look at, but also more comfortable to hold.

Behind the transparent rear panel, you can see the entire Glyph system with the same design as before, but now, broken up into smaller segments. The components inside are neat and look lovely, you will see a few exposed Torx screws and a bunch of panels hiding the innards. No inconsistent glue work and no unsightly wires – just pure art.



In my opinion, at least. There's personality, for sure. Whether you call the glyphs a gimmick or not, it is eye-catching, no doubt. And the rest of the build, including the gentle curve of the rear glass panel, the brushed aluminium frame, and the lovely symmetrical bezels, all look top-notch and premium. The Phone (2), however, is only IP54 rated which is slightly disappointing since it still can't survive a submersion.

DISPLAY

Tucked in between those gorgeous symmetrical bezels is a 6.7-inch LTPO OLED FHD+ display with a peak brightness of 1,000 nits. It can reach up to 1,600 nits in HDR video playback. It supports 10-bit colour and HDR10+ as well. The LTPO display, in theory, can vary the refresh rate all the way from 1 Hz up to 120 Hz to conserve battery life,

however, I have never seen it drop below 10 Hz in about 5 days' worth of usage. What's even more appalling is that the display bumps up the refresh rate to 120 Hz on the Always-On Display, which is just ridiculous.

The display is quite bright for the price. I recorded 988 nits of peak brightness on Auto Brightness mode and 506 nits when I cranked up the brightness to max manually. Screen legibility is excellent in sunlight and the viewing angles are impressive too. The display supports DCI-P3 and sRGB colour spaces and it looks very vibrant when watching HDR content on YouTube. Netflix did not detect it as HDR-capable, sadly.

GLYPH INTERFACE

Possibly the biggest driver for sales of the Nothing Phone (2), the glyph interface is now much more beefed up than the original version on the Phone (1). There's more customisation than ever before with new features and third-party app integrations that make it more of a utility than a gimmick.

Let's address all the functions. There's 10 new ringtones and notification sounds, but if that doesn't satisfy you, Nothing has added a Glyph composer this time around. Nothing has also added Essential Glyph Notifications. So, if you want to avoid distractions but still be notified by what's really important to you, you can select particular apps or contacts that will be able to get through to you when others won't disturb you. There's also a Flip to Glyph feature that auto-silences the phone in an instant when you place it screen down.

What's most exciting is the third-party app integrations we've got this time around. For now, two apps have been added – Uber and Zomato. An LED segment acts as a progress bar for your Uber and food deliveries, so you can see exactly how far your ride or your food is from you. All without turning on the display.

The glyphs have a purpose – it is attempting to provide a way to be more